Conflicts at Work

Handling Conflict

1. What is the biggest conflict you have had at work? How did you handle it?
2. How do you feel when a conflict starts? Do you stay calm or get nervous?
3. Do you deal with a problem at once, or wait until you cool down?
4. Have you ever made a conflict worse by saying the wrong thing?
5. What could you do better the next time a conflict comes up?
6. Do you talk to the person directly, or go to your manager first?
7. Is it ever better to just let a small problem go? When?

What Would You Do?

1. A colleague takes credit for your idea in a meeting. What do you do?
2. Your manager sets a deadline you know is impossible. How do you respond?
3. A teammate keeps missing deadlines. How do you bring it up?
4. You are paired with someone whose work style is the opposite of yours?
5. Two colleagues are shouting at each other in a meeting. Do you step in?
6. You feel underpaid next to your peers. How do you raise it with your boss?
7. Your boss asks you to do work outside your job description. What now?
8. You suspect the boss's favourite always gets the promotion. What do you do?
9. Work pressure is burning you out. How do you tell your manager?
10. Cultural differences are causing tension in your team. How do you fix it?

When It Gets Personal

1. A colleague says something rude about your work in front of others. Now what?
2. Someone keeps interrupting you in every meeting. How do you handle it?

3. A teammate never replies to your messages. How do you get an answer?
4. Your boss criticises you in front of the whole team. What do you say?
5. A friend at work is angry that you got the project, not them. What do you do?
6. Two teammates are not speaking, and you are in the middle. What now?
7. A colleague shares your private chat with the team. What do you do?

Keeping the Peace

1. How do you disagree with your boss without sounding rude?
2. What is the best way to give someone bad news about their work?
3. How do you say "no" to a colleague without hurting the friendship?
4. Do you apologise when you are wrong, even if it feels awkward?
5. How can a team argue well and still stay friendly the next day?
6. Is it ever fine to go over your manager's head? When?
7. What does a good apology sound like at work?

Lessons Learned

1. What conflict have you learned the most from? What happened?
2. Do you argue more with bosses or with people at your own level? Why?
3. Is a team with no conflict a good team, or a silent one?
4. How does culture change what counts as rude at work?
5. Have you ever seen a small argument turn into a big problem?
6. What would you do differently in your last conflict?
7. What is the one rule you follow in every conflict?

Your Own Examples

1. What would be a real, serious conflict for you? Why?
2. Can you write down three conflicts you can easily let go of?